FACULTY REFERENCE · OCTOBER 2026

What This Is
And What It Is Not

One page, before you adopt it. What the suite contains, what it is built on, what it deliberately leaves out, and the three things it cannot do for you.

51 resources | Years 7–10 | Dry-land deliverable | CC BY 4.0

What it is

A complete, free water safety teaching unit for Victorian secondary HPE, in two bands. **51 resources** — eleven lesson plans, student workbooks at three levels of scaffolding, assessment rubrics and checklists, scenario cards, posters, question banks, parent information in several languages, and faculty reference documents. Every resource is also a PDF, and the whole suite downloads as a single file.

- **Years 7–8** — five 50-minute lessons: Victorian drowning data, beach flags and rips, DRS ABCD and rescue, inland waterways and alcohol, and a summative communication campaign.
- **Years 9–10** — six 50-minute lessons: data analysis, the physiology of drowning and CPR, social determinants of risk, prevention strategy evaluation, diving and spinal injury, and a community action project.
- **A pool practical companion** — four sessions, for schools that have water access.

It is deliverable without a pool. That is the design premise, not a fallback: every lesson in both bands runs in a classroom. The practical companion is an addition for schools that can offer it, and there is a pathway for students who do not enter water.

What it is built on

Foundation	How it is used
Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0	Every code verified against the VCAA export. The unit addresses 10 of the 40 HPE content descriptions across Levels 7–10, plus cross-curricular English codes in the literacy and debate resources. The Curriculum Coverage Map states which codes it teaches and which it does not.
Australian Curriculum V9.0	A full code-by-code comparison for schools outside Victoria, including the movement-strand offset that makes a straight number-for-number substitution wrong, and a localisation guide for swapping Victorian statistics, organisations and legislation.
VTLM 2.0	All eleven lessons follow the explicit teaching sequence — review, focus the learning, I do, we do, you do, monitor progress. Audited against all 14 teaching strategies in October 2026.
Life Saving Victoria and Royal Life Saving Australia data	Victorian figures from the LSV *Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25*; national figures from the RLSSA *National Drowning Report 2026*. Every figure is traced to a source and page in `DATA_PROVENANCE.md`, with its limitations stated where they matter.

What it is *not*

Four of these are deliberate scope decisions. Three are things no set of documents can do. Knowing which is which is the point of this page.

Not this	Why
Not an HPE program	**By design.** It services the *Safety* focus area substantially and contributes to three others. It does not cover the remaining eight focus areas, and the coverage map lists every content description it leaves for your program to place elsewhere.
Not a swimming program	**By design.** It teaches water safety knowledge, judgement and emergency response. It does not teach anyone to swim, and it is not a substitute for the Victorian Water Safety Certificate or in-water instruction.
Not evidence of student achievement	**By design.** The curriculum codes record what was *taught*. Victorian Curriculum 2.0 reports against achievement standards, and that evidence comes from the rubrics, work samples and your moderation.
Not a tiered intervention	**By design.** The scaffolded and simplified versions are Tier 1 differentiation. Tier 2 and 3 intervention is designed around a student, by your school, on data this unit does not hold.
Not a substitute for your wellbeing or child safety policy	**Cannot be.** This unit teaches death by drowning using real cases. It carries a cultural safety protocol — advance notice, opt-outs, First Nations protocols around deceased persons — written to defer to your school's processes. Where they differ, follow your school.
Not a record of your teaching practice	**Cannot be.** Classroom routines, active supervision, flexible grouping formed on what you see in the room, and the relationships you build with students and families are prompted by these materials and evidenced only by you.
Not whole-school VTLM implementation	**Cannot be.** The VTLM 2.0 Implementation Rubric assesses consistency *across* a school. One unit is a data point, not a program.

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What it was audited against, and what it still owes

In October 2026 the suite was rebuilt against VTLM 2.0 and audited against all 14 of its teaching strategies, the Implementation Rubric and the Elements of Teaching Reflection Tool. The result: **seven strategies addressed, five partly, two out of scope** for any set of documents. Twenty technique-level gaps were found and **nineteen closed**.

One remains open: flexible grouping formed and re-formed on evidence of learning during a lesson. The materials prompt it; they cannot script it, because it depends on what the teacher is seeing. Both teacher guides say so in their own pages rather than leaving it in the audit.

Two honest caveats about the audit itself. The department's Elements of Teaching Reflection Tool states that it covers Planning, Explicit teaching and Supported application only, with Enabling learning to follow — so one element of this mapping has no departmental scoring instrument behind it yet. And the strategy this suite best serves, *Develop and deliver quality curriculum materials*, asks for materials developed *collaboratively by a school's teachers*. A faculty adopting these and refining them together is what satisfies that practice. Downloading them is not.

Licence, attribution and currency

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- **Figures go stale annually.** The Victorian figures are from the 2024–25 LSV report; the 2025–26 report is due late 2026. `DATA_PROVENANCE.md` lists which file carries which figure and is the checklist for that update.
- **If you adapt it, keep the source citations.** They are what make the claims checkable, and a resource whose numbers cannot be traced is worth less than one with fewer of them.

The short version

A curriculum-aligned, evidence-sourced, dry-land-deliverable water safety unit for Years 7–10, free to use and adapt, with its data traceable and its limits written down. It will not teach your students to swim, it will not cover your HPE program, and it will not evidence your teaching or your school's VTLM implementation. Everything it claims to do, it states; everything it does not do, it also states.

Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0 · Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0 · Health and Physical Education · Levels 7–10
51 resources. Audited October 2026 against all 14 VTLM 2.0 teaching strategies.

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Data sources cited in this resource. Drowning statistics are reproduced with attribution from: Life Saving Victoria. (2025). *Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25*. Life Saving Victoria: Melbourne. Royal Life Saving Australia (2026). *National Drowning Report 2026*. RLSSA: Sydney. Surf Life Saving Australia (2026). *Summer Coastal Drowning Report 2025/26*. SLSA: Sydney. These figures remain the property of the publishing organisations. If you adapt this resource, retain these citations.

Sources cited in this resource. Life Saving Victoria. *Victorian Drowning Report 2024–25*. Royal Life Saving Society Australia. *National Drowning Report 2026*. Victorian Curriculum and Assessment Authority. *Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0*. Department of Education Victoria. *Victorian Teaching and Learning Model 2.0*. These remain the property of their publishers. If you adapt this resource, retain these citations.